

MP3 or AAC files.

The Wii Shop Channel allows users to download games and other software by redeeming Wii Points, which can be obtained by purchasing Wii Points (Nintendo Points) cards from retail outlets or directly through the Shop Channel using MasterCard or Visa credit cards online.

The Wii Shop contains three main sub-categories: virtual console (which lets you buy old games that are playable via an emulator), WiiWare (small-budget arcade games created by independent developers) and Wii Channels (where you can buy extra channels, such as the Internet Channel).

When the Wii is connected to the internet, the Forecast and News channels, obviously, show status updates about the latest weather and news headlines from across the globe.

2.3.4 WHY IT RULES

A hacker's delight – now, while we do not condone piracy, it is still one of the major factors when buying a console in India. But more importantly, a few simple hacks can get you to derive a lot more out of a console than you ever thought possible.

Neither the Xbox 360 nor the PlayStation 3 are particularly welcoming towards piracy. While Microsoft's console can be cracked to play pirated disks, it does void the warranty; and with the probability of an RROD looming large, you don't want to be left with a bricked console in your hands. Meanwhile, the copy protection in the PlayStation 3 has somehow still been impossible to crack for the millions of pirates out there.

On the other hand, the Wii has been the easiest of the lot to be unlocked. Several 'homebrew' communities online have detailed instructions on how to crack the console to not only play pirated games, but also get the Wii to perform tasks such as playing DVD video disks.

2.3.5 WHY IT SUCKS

Disdain for graphics – don't get us wrong, we realise that the Nintendo Wii is not meant to be a graphical delight like the Xbox 360 or the PS3. But really, when you have such eye candy available for the other consoles, the pangs of jealousy are quite overpowering.

The Wii's graphics look outdated at best, and ignore the realism aspect of modern gaming. All the major titles are focused on a cartoon-like feel, with exaggerated animation styles taking precedence over realistic graphics.

While this works for a while, over time, you start missing the good old graphics. And in cross-platform titles such as *Need For Speed* and *Call of Duty*, it becomes painfully obvious what you are missing.